



Daniel W. Heintz
VICE PRESIDENT
ENVIRONMENTAL AFFAIRS



May 26, 1998

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Division of Minerals & Geology

Mr. Richard Cargill
St. Vrain Valley Community Watchdogs
5976 Hygiene Road
Longmont, Co. 80503

Dear Mr. Cargill:

I am writing to you in response to your letter to Mr. Clarence Comer, President and CEO of Southdown, Inc. I am the Vice President of Environmental Affairs and generally get involved in matters such as those described in your letter. Let me start by saying that we take great pride in being a good corporate citizen and an environmentally responsible employer. We take very seriously letters, such as yours, from citizens in the local communities in which our plants operate. Please be assured that the concerns expressed in your letter are receiving our full consideration.

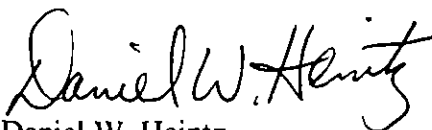
I have spoken with John Lohr, the plant manager, about the nature of activities that have the potential to cause dust emissions. Although our Lyons plant has been manufacturing a product that we believe benefits society for over 29 years, we are spending a substantial amount of money and effort to reduce the amount of dust that leaves our property. For example, we are transitioning to a new dust storage area this summer. We have covered a large portion of the existing dust storage area, which should minimize the potential for dust to become airborne during high winds. Work to cover the remainder of this area has been accelerated to complete closure of this storage area. In addition, watering of the haul roads occurs whenever needed to keep dust down from truck traffic. We also plan to apply a special dust suppression agent on the haul roads sometime in the next few weeks, which should prove to be more effective than watering.

I have instructed Steve Mossberg, our plant environmental manager, to contact you to discuss specific concerns that you have and to explore other opportunities that we may undertake to minimize dust emissions. I look forward to hearing back from him on this matter.

Mr. Cargill, we wish to work cooperatively with you and your organization. We have found communication and not antagonism to be the most effective means of resolving matters of mutual interest. As an employer that provides a livelihood for over 90 people in the community,

we want to be a good neighbor. Should you have any questions regarding this letter or other matters, please do not hesitate to contact either John Lohr or me.

Sincerely,



Daniel W. Heintz
Vice President
Environmental Affairs

DWH:idr

cc: Mr. Robert Jorgenson
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Mr. Jeff Zayach
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Mr. John Lohr
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